

Propylene Glycol



What is it?

Propylene glycol is used as a softening agent, solvent, moisturizer, preservative or vehicle. It is in many personal products, medications (including creams, ointments and solutions), and industries.

PROPYLENE GLYCOL can also be known as:

- Methylethyl glycol
- Propane - 1,2 - diol or 1,2 - propanediol
- 2 - hydroxypropanol
- 1,2 - dihydroxypropane
- Isopropylene glycol
- E1520

Some Possible Uses of PROPYLENE GLYCOL

/ Where it might be found:

- Shampoo, hair conditioner, hair color
- Hair gel, detangler, hair styling products
- Body lotion, cream, massage oil
- Bar soap, cleanser, body wash, bubble bath, shower gel
- Shaving cream, aftershave
- Face cream and lotion
- Facial cleanser, face wipe, toner
- Anti-aging products, Eye cream
- Make-up: blush, bronzer, concealer, eye shadow, eyeliner, foundation, lip products, mascara
- Antiperspirant, deodorant
- Cologne, perfume
- Moist towelettes, baby wipes, body wipes
- Hand sanitizer, hand soap, foot cream
- Toothpaste, tooth whiteners
- Mouthwash, denture care
- Contact solution, Eye drops
- Cuticle remover, Nail polish
- Sunscreen, after-sun care
- Feminine hygiene, personal lubricant
- Dish soap, laundry detergent

- Household cleaning wipes
- Pet shampoo, spray, and deodorizer
- Insect repellent
- Aircraft de-icing fluid
- Antifreeze
- Artificial smoke generation
- Automotive care, brake fluid, tire sealant
- Caulk, joint compound
- Cryonics
- ECG gel
- Engine coolant, Hydraulic press fluid
- Fermentation tank cooling agent
- Fragrance oils
- Heat transfer fluid
- Industrial solvent
- Insect trap contents
- Paint, enamel, stain, deck coat, varnish
- Paintball ingredient
- Photographic chemical
- Pitfall trap for ground beetles
- Plasticizer, polyester and alkyd resins
- Polyurethane cushion
- Printing fountain ink solution, roller wash
- Tobacco humectant, cigar humidifier
- Transcutaneous nerve stimulator gel
- UV tattoo ink
- Wallpaper stripper, drywall primer
- Water proofing, crack sealant

Some medicated products *may* contain propylene glycol. Some examples include:

Topical:

- Cold sore creams
- Many topical steroids
- Acne treatments (adapalene, Akief, azaleic acid, Cabtreo, clindamycin, tazarotene, tretinoin, Winlevi)
- Anti-fungal products (oxiconazole, ketoconazole, terconazole)
- Anti-itch products

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Propylene Glycol



- Bleaching cream
- Calcipotriene solution and ointment
- Cetany (mupirocin) ointment
- Diaper rash treatment
- Earwax removal kits
- Ear medications
- Eucrisa
- Eye medications, Eye drops
- First aid cream
- Fluoruracil cream, solution
- Minoxidil solution
- Opzelura
- Pain relief formulations
- Pimecrolimus cream
- Rosacea treatments (azaleic acid, ivermectin*, metronidazole)
- VTAMA
- Wound care products
- Zoryve*

*contains hexylene glycol

Oral:

- Clarithromycin
- Cyclosporine
- Dipyridamole
- Methylphenidate
- Mycophenolate mofetil
- Look for it in OTC pills (i.e. acetaminophen, cetirizine, ibuprofen, coated aspirin, glucosamine chondroitin sulfate)

Injectable:

- Cetirizine
- Diazepam, lorazepam, phenytoin

For further information, please refer to:
<https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/>

Other products that may cross react to

PROPYLENE GLYCOL:

- Propylene glycol stearate
- Dipropylene glycol
- Butylene glycol
- Hexylene glycol

Propylene glycol will likely not cross react to:

- Caprylyl glycol
- Pentyleneglycol

What should I do to avoid PROPYLENE GLYCOL?

Read the ingredient list on the label of each item you use. Look for propylene glycol or one of its other names given above.

Some product ingredient lists are available at manufacturer or store websites.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS). Check the complete ingredient list of each product you use. Use heavy duty gloves if you must contact this allergen. Ask your medical provider, nurse, hairdresser, and others to avoid using this allergen in your care.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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